

IN PROFILE

Albrecht V of Bavaria

Duke Albrecht V (1528–1579), ruler of Bavaria from 1550 until his death, was a prominent Renaissance patron of the arts. Also a leading figure in the Counter-Reformation, he strictly imposed Catholicism in his domain, but by natural inclination he was a hedonist and an aesthete. He amassed a magnificent collection of Roman and Greek antiquities, books, jewels, sculptures, and paintings. Employing Lassus enabled him to make his Munich court the major center of music in Europe outside Italy. The duke's lavish expenditure on collections and patronage left Bavaria heavily in debt.



ALBRECHT V OF BAVARIA WITH A LION, HANS MIELICH, 1556

Orlande de Lassus was born at Mons in the Hapsburg-ruled Netherlands (now Belgium), an area renowned for Renaissance music. Much about his origins is uncertain. His birth may have occurred in 1530 or 1532; nothing is known of his parents. His